

greater than they were before the two of them made the acquaintance.

The last day of the Merrill Lynch course the phones were plugged into the outside world and the recruits went live, using Merrill Lynch's Familiar Quotations to set up appointments back home. I wasn't allowed to participate directly, but I sat in on the impressive chorus of a roomful of brokers, all saying things like, "Hello, this is Jim Reynolds from Merrill Lynch. I'm interested in people with financial objectives who are interested in reaching their financial objectives. Do you have time to talk? . . . How about next week?"

I left the training camp with deep affection for the friends I'd made, but convinced that being a stockbroker was not for me. In that field, there's no time to think about stocks and bonds. I'm glad I realized it early enough to avoid the full commitment. From Merrill Lynch boot camp, I returned to New York, anxious to get back to the subject.